

Process and Decision Documentation

For this Side Quest, one of the main decisions I made was choosing what emotions I wanted the moving circle to display. I was responsible for all of the creative choices, including adding flowers in the field and placing hidden smiley faces that would only occasionally appear for the camera to discover. I also designed a warning sign that would pop up if the smiley ball controlled by the player moved too close to the edge of the map. In addition, I decided how each extra feature would look by carefully selecting their colours and overall visual style. These decisions shaped the overall mood and personality of the project and helped make the experience feel more intentional and cohesive.

GenAI Documentation

Date Used: Feb 14-15th, 2026

Tool Disclosure: ChatGPT 5.2

Purpose of Use: GenAI helped me write code that felt too complicated for my skills. This allowed me to turn my ideas into actual working features. I was able to better understand how the code worked together by seeing it clearly structured with comments beside it. Overall, it made the development process more manageable and productive.

Summary of Interaction:

- Asked GenAI to explain each file in the codebase to better understand the project structure and functionality and what is the purpose of each file for this specific Side Quest for Week 5.
- Asked for technical support to help write code that would bring my creative ideas to working code.
- Asked for help implementing a background effect where the green colour gradually becomes darker toward the edges of the canvas.
- Asked for help to generate visual elements such as flowers and rare smiley faces in terms of code.
- I selected and decided on the colours and visual features of the elements.
- Asked for help creating a warning sign that appears when the player gets close to the end of the canvas.
- Used GenAI as a technical support tool while maintaining creative control over the design decisions.

Human Decision Point(s):

- I chose the overall colour scheme for this side quest.
- I also made all major creative decisions regarding the visual style and design.
- I selected the specific colours and features for elements such as flowers and smiley faces.

- Reviewed the generated code and edited it when it did not match my creative ideas and what I wanted it to look like.
- Changed the background colour from a bright green to a more muted green to better fit the intended aesthetic and made the flowers and smiley faces stand out more instead of clashing with the background.

Integrity & Verification Note: When I did not understand the code that GenAI was writing, I made sure to ask for a clear and detailed explanation rather than simply copying and pasting it into my project. I asked it to break down what each section of the code was doing, explain the purpose of specific functions and variables, and clarify how different parts of the code were connected. This helped me understand not just what the code did, but why it worked the way it did. I also asked for comments beside lines of code that did not make sense to me

Scope of GenAI Use: GenAI did not help me come up with ideas. It was only used to help me create my own original ideas and thoughts.

Limitations or Misfires: When the code gets too long and detailed the GenAI has a hard time reading it which means that I would have to debug the code myself sometimes. I had to either section it off and feed it to the GenAI or I have to completely figure it out myself. To do this I have to backtrack and delete the additional new lines of code I added and view in a live server to see what line of code broke the entire file.

Summary of Process (Human + Tool):

- Used GenAI to help write and structure code for features and mechanics.
- I came up with all my creative ideas, including the concept and the design of levels.
- Asked GenAI to explain code when it was unclear so I could understand and edit it myself.
- The process was to ask the AI to write code to express my idea then it would give me something super odd looking in terms of colours and design, so I would reprompt it and give details about the colour and shape and I would repeat until I felt satisfied with my side quest.
- Directed GenAI to implement specific visual effects like:
 - Making the green background gradually darker toward the edges.
 - Drawing flowers and rare smiley faces with chosen colours and styles.
 - Creating a warning sign that appears near the end of the canvas.
- Made edits to code when it did not match my vision (like changing the background from bright green to muted green).
- When code became too long or complex for GenAI to interpret, I debugged and fixed issues myself.
- Used GenAI as a technical support tool, while I retained creative control over key decisions and visuals.

Decision Points & Trade-offs: Using GenAI means the code can get really long and confusing when theres a shorter and easier more simplified way of doing it. But unless you spficy you want

it to be simple it won't take that route. It also can not catch its own mistakes and can be repetitive which is frustrating.

Verification & Judgement: I always make sure to look over each of the lines code and comments beside it so I know what each line is doing and understand its purpose.

Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions: GenAI has a hard time debugging code unless you explain the situation super detailedly which takes a long time so I end up debugging my own code.

Appendix

<https://chatgpt.com/share/699628fc-ca4c-800c-ac08-c0f1549e6da4>